

Practice Test II, 2025-2026

Class X

English (Code 184)

Time:3 hours

Maximum Marks:80

Answer Key

[This document contains the most relevant answers to the questions present in the Question paper.]

General Instructions:

Read the instructions very carefully and strictly follow them:

- 1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.*
- 2. The question paper contains THREE sections.*
- 3. Section– A: Reading Skills*

Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills

Section – C: Literature

- 4. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.*

SECTION A – READING SKILL

20 marks

1.Read the passage and answer the following questions.

1. Let's say, you're visiting a distinct town and wish to visit famous food joints specific to the place. Who will inform you of the tastiest food around? What if I tell you there are several food bloggers and vloggers who explore food from restaurants and eateries to margin stalls and street food. There are many food enthusiasts for whom food could be a passion and a profession. As they assert, "*Do what you like the foremost,*" these food bloggers have centred their profession around the factor they love- *the love for food*.
2. Food bloggers document their expertise of tasting food or maybe the method of preparing food for his or her readers. Some kitchen-specific food bloggers present their recipes in a manner that enriches the readers with informative and interesting content.
3. Food vlogging could be a comparatively new term within the lexicon of YouTube, and if you've maintained with the past trends, you would possibly be accustomed to some very popular food vloggers. Anyone with a camera and a passion for food will jump into food vlogging. Vloggers video their food experiences and share them on widespread social media websites for their audience. Since this can be a dynamic variety of blogging, food vlogging quickly picked up the pace and became popular among the

young audience furthermore as food enthusiasts prefer the video format instead of reading. Food vloggers video not solely the food but additionally the method of preparation, the stories of the food places and the culture that surrounds the food. Viewers additionally relish the video format, providing them moving picture shows.

4. Taking up blogging as a career is also an excellent way to travel to one's favourite places to explore food and thus the origins of the cuisine. There seem to be several stories hidden within a dish. You get to learn a lot and share your knowledge with the world while also earning money. Chefs and presenters get an opportunity to create an audience outside traditional TV channels, as was the case before.
5. A favoured YouTuber and Vlogger is recognized for her cooking and travel vlogs. Her YouTube channel subscribers considerably increased once she started posting videos of ancient Rajasthani cooking. She travels to cities everywhere in the country to try the simplest dishes and native delicacies.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above. 10

- I. How are passion and profession related in the life of a food vlogger? (1)

passion: explore food from restaurants and eateries to margin stalls and street food
profession: earn a lot of money through their vlogs.

- II. All the following statements are True, **EXCEPT-** (1)

- a) Food blogging is about commenting on the taste of various dishes.
- b) Food bloggers share their expertise of tasting food in their blogs.
- c) Food blogging also tells us much about the recipes of different dishes.
- d) Food bloggers' blogs are not interesting, and the accounts of food preparation turn out to be very boring.

- III. Complete the following by selecting the correct option from those given in brackets.

(1)

The term "lexicon of YouTube" means (the vocabulary commonly used in the content of YouTube/ audiovisual dictionary)

- IV. Which of the following qualities (a-d) **CANNOT** be associated with Food Vlogging.

(1)

- a) Passion for food
- b) Penchant for creative writing
- c) Wonderful sense of Videography
- d) Interest in the ethnicity of food

- V. Complete the analogy by selecting one of the two options (a), (b) (1)

exposed: hidden :: _____ : _____

a) modern : traditional

b) chance: opportunity

VI. Mention two benefits that Food Vlogging provides the Vloggers other than being able to taste different kinds of food and learning new recipes. (2)

--travel to different places where they explore food and share your knowledge with the world ---- also earn money.

VII. Which option correctly indicates the ideas of Paragraphs 4 and 5? (1)

- i. Chefs get to show their culinary skills only on the traditional TV channels.
- ii. The scope and opportunities offered by food vlogging
- iii. Ancient Rajasthani cooking made a YouTube Vlog an instant hit.
- iv. A famous food Vlogger began to lose subscribers when she started writing travel stories.
- v. A popular Vlogger uses her You Tube channel to focus on ancient sites in Rajasthan .

OPTIONS	IDEA OF PARAGRAPH 4	IDEA OF PARAGRAPH 5
A	i	iv
B	v	ii
C	iii	i
D	ii	iii

VIII. Why is the Vlog on the You Tube focusing on Rajasthan referred to in the quoted extract popular among viewers? (2)

Gives us a glimpse of:

- the places the vlogger visits in Rajasthan
- ancient Rajasthani cooking and native delicacies, hitherto unknown to the world

2. Read the passage and answer the following questions

1. Fragrances and lotions don't just change the way people smell, they actively alter the indoor air chemistry around the wearer, disrupting a critical natural process the body uses to protect itself from pollution. Personal care products like perfumes and even unscented lotions alter the chemical composition of the “human oxidation field”, a natural protective air shield around a person’s breathing zone and skin. The products disrupt how skin oils naturally react with indoor ozone to produce highly reactive hydroxyl (OH) radicals. Those radicals play a key role in forming an invisible chemical field around the person that protects them from ozone exposure. Chemicals emitted from scented products can also trigger or worsen sinus irritation, congestion, headaches, and related discomfort—particularly for those with allergies, asthma, or other respiratory sensitivities.

2. Indoor air quality is a major factor in humans’ overall exposure to chemical pollutants. The research team conducted experiments where volunteers sat in a controlled chamber with ozone present. They found that applying the products substantially disrupted the natural human oxidation field. The unscented lotion caused a roughly 170% increase in OH reactivity, which led to a roughly 140% decrease in OH concentrations around the wearer, meaning their natural ozone barrier was less than half as strong because the OH radicals were floating off into the air instead of forming a protective force field. The researchers found that the effects of lotion tend to be more persistent over time compared to fragrance. The fragrance effects were stronger initially but less persistent than lotions, as the organic compounds in fragrances, like ethanol, broke down more rapidly into the gas phase and were dispersed more broadly into the air.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

(10)

1. What was the aim behind the study?

(1)

----to find how fragrances and lotions affect us

2. Identify the expression from Paragraph 1 which refers to a safeguarding mechanism in human beings, against pollution. (1)

---‘human oxidation field’

3. Complete the following by selecting the correct option from those given in the brackets.

(1)

Hydroxyl radicals are created due to a reaction between human skin oils and ozone. They offer humans.....ozone. (exposure to / protection from)

4. What does the writer mean by “trigger” when referring to the chemicals emitted from scented products? (1)

----refers to the idea of the initiation of an episode of discomfort due to the emission of the chemicals.

5. Complete the following with the correct option. (1)

The research findings note that people affected with respiratory malaise are particularly vulnerable to suffer from exposure to chemicals emitted from scented products. Based on this premise, we can safely assume that will surely display symptoms of respiratory discomfort in the presence of a perfume.

- A. a person, with no history of previous cases of sensitivity from scented products,
- B. a person, suffering from common cold and prone to quick reactions to different kinds of allergens,
- C. a person, with a partial or complete loss of the ability to smell due to neurological issues,
- D. a person, with lower body paralysis caused by a spinal cord injury,

6. Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. (1)

The study has exposed the fact that humans can come into close contact with.....pollutants even by staying in the protective confines of their own homes. ---chemical

7. How did the use of a controlled chamber act as an important component of the research?

(1)

----make comparative analysis of the impact of perfumes and unscented lotions on individuals.

8. Complete the following appropriately. (1)

The research finding that there was a ‘170% increase in OH reactivity leading to a roughly 140% decrease in OH concentrations around the wearer’, points to the fact that the wearer’s.....was compromised.

----- natural ozone barrier / human oxidation field

9. Elaborate, according to the research findings, how lotions and fragrances affect our immediate surroundings differently. (2)

----disrupt the human oxidation field---the fragrances initially have stronger effect but less persistent than lotions---- the organic compounds in fragrances, like ethanol, break down more rapidly into the gas phase and disperse more broadly into the air.

SECTION B - WRITING SKILLS & GRAMMAR

(20 marks)

GRAMMAR

(10)

3. Complete ANY TEN of the following twelve tasks, as directed. (1x10=10)

- I. Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in brackets for the given portion of a business report:

The latest advertising strategies have been carefully _____ (formulate) to target a diverse group of young consumers effectively. ----- formulated

- II. Identify the error and write the correction in the given sentence from a motivational article:

Every student in the leadership programme were encouraged to share his opinion openly. Use the given format:

Error	Correction
were	was

- III. Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb given in brackets:

By the time we reached the station, the passengers _____ (board) the train.

---- had boarded

- IV. Report the question that Della asked her brother.

“Can you help me finish the work before I leave for London tomorrow?”

Della asked her brother if /whether he could help her finish the work before she left for London the next day.

V. Fill in the blank to complete the conclusion of a letter of complaint:

We hope you will take prompt action _____ our request.

- A.in
- B.by
- C.with
- D. **at**

VI. Report the following by completing the sentence correctly:

“Don’t tell anyone about this until I give you permission,” the manager instructed them strictly.

The manager strictly instructed them _____.

--- not to tell anyone about that until he gave them permission

VII. Complete the given opinion by filling in the blank with the correct option: The pleasant weather left everyone _____ cheerful throughout the day.

- A. feels
- B. felt
- C. **feeling**
- D. having felt

VIII. The given question has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies the error and the correction:

The committee has decided to postpone their meeting until next week .

No.	Error	Correction
A.	has decided	decided
B.	postpone	postponed
C.	their	its
D.	next	following

IX. Report the following question:

He said to me, “Will you come to the conference in Delhi tomorrow if you are free?”

He asked me whether _____.

---I would come to the conference in Delhi the day after if I was free.

X. Fill in the blank with the correct option from those given in brackets:
You _____ (must / might) complete the assignment before Friday; it's compulsory.

XI. Fill in the blank to complete the sentence:
_____ of the two sisters was willing to share the secret with anyone.

A. **Neither**

B. Most

C. Both

D. All

XII. Choose the correct option to fill in the blank:
There were _____ chairs in the hall, so none of guests had to stand during the function.

A. few

B. **a few**

C. no

D. fewer

WRITING

(10)

4A. You have read an article in The Times on "Sluggishness in youngsters due to overuse of cell phones leading to decreased productivity" Draft a letter to the Editor of The Times in 120 words stating your views as a student in response to the article. You are Raj/ Romita. (5)

Format as taught in class

□ Content---

Suggested points---

occupied with cell phones--- do not indulge in physical activities, sports--- stamina getting reduced--- more interested in watching, observing rather than

engage in the application of mind etc--- effects

OR

4B. You visited the Kquality Electronics Store to diagnose your cell phone issues. Draft a letter to the Manager of Kquality Electronics Store in 120 words complaining against the lack of courtesy and severe inefficiency of the technical support in their dealings with customers. You are Vijay / Vinita. (5)

□ Format as taught in class

□ Content--- Suggested points - lacks courtesy— rude behaviour – impatient— not willing to listen to customers' views—rather slow in responding—

inefficiency in diagnosing the cause – other outlets could fix it more efficiently and without delay.

□ Other relevant ideas

5A. Mahesh is the President of the Theatre and Drama Society of ABC School, Kolkata. During Christmas, there will be a presentation of "A Midsummer Night's Dream" by the school students with him directing the play. Mahesh has advertised for an Assistant Director and has received two mails from two interested individuals. Given below are the excerpts of the two mails. Write an analytical paragraph based on these excerpts in 120 words and write whom Mahesh will choose for the role of an assistant director. (5)

Giev:

....I can develop a clear overarching idea for plays and concepts on how they will be staged, and can inspire and encourage actors especially amateurs. I communicate well with students, can motivate them, and have a keen eye for details. I am able to manage complex schedules. I can empathize with student - actors who may not fare well and tutor them to rectify their errors. Regards

Ravi:

.....I am confident and able to take quick decisions, can inspire and encourage only seasoned actors. I can clearly communicate and meticulously plan. I have good problem solving skills and can be a strong support for the director. I can examine scripts deeply and have good technical knowledge. Regards

Format – as taught in class

Content—

Giev--- more suitable candidate--- competent—especially when it comes to helping amateur actors – students are not generally seasoned actors—elaborate – compare the strengths and weaknesses of the candidate -- Inference

OR

5B. Tennis doubles need teamwork, communication and coordinated strategy. Amita has very quick reflexes, varied strategies and can effectively communicate while playing. As her partner is injured, Amita requires one for the upcoming tennis doubles Hudson Cup. Write an analytical paragraph in 120 words on whom Amita will choose from the three players of the Tennis Academy. Her partner needs to complement her strengths and cover her weaknesses.

(5)

Aisha:

Can exploit opponent weakness but poor in verbal and non-verbal cues during a match, strong backhand, needs to work on footwork, can strategise.

Rina:

Can exploit gaps in opponent's defence, coordinate averagely with partner during a match, strong backhand, fairly good in strategic shots, difficulty in covering weakness of partner.

Gurpreet:

Excellent partner synergy, sharing of responsibilities, synchronized movements, weak backhand, fairly good footwork, varied tactics.

Format as taught in class

Content—

Gurpreet should be inducted as Amita's partner-----excellent partner synergy, sharing of responsibilities, synchronized movements, fairly good footwork, varied tactics--- weak backhand compensated by her strengths and Amita's quick reflexes---- make a comparative study taking into account the others' strengths and weaknesses--- reiterate your Inference.

SECTION C--LITERATURE 40 marks

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer any one of the two. (5)

A. Two days later, Mijbil escaped from my bedroom as I entered it, and I turned to see his tail disappearing round the bend of the corridor that led to the bathroom. By the time I got there he was up on the end of the bathtub and fumbling at the chromium taps with his paws. I watched, amazed; in less than a minute he had turned the tap far enough to produce a trickle of water, and after a moment or two achieved the full flow. (He had been lucky to turn the tap the right way; on later occasions he would sometimes screw it up still tighter, chittering with irritation and disappointment at the tap's failure to cooperate.)

- i. Validate with points from the extract the idea that Mijbil was a curious and intelligent animal.

(2)

entered the bathroom, curious to know what lay there---- and fumbling at the chromium taps with his paws--- in less than a minute he had turned the tap far enough to produce a trickle of water, and after a moment or two achieved the full flow though perhaps luck played a part too.

- ii. Which of the following is true with regard to the narrator's relation with Mijbil?

(1)

- a. The narrator found it difficult to deal with Mijbil's tantrums .
b. The narrator was almost obsessed with Mijbil and was fascinated by his skills.

- iii. Was Mijbil always happy manoeuvring the tap? Answer with reference to the quoted

extract.

(1)

On occasions when Mijbil could not open the tap after screwing up tightly he was irritated and chattered in disappointment

- iv. The portion in parentheses has been added to introduce a note of _____
(pathos/humour) (1)

OR

B. Fifteen years ago, Horace had served his first and only sentence in a prison library. He loved rare, expensive books. So he robbed a safe every year. Each year he planned carefully just what he would do, stole enough to last for twelve months, and secretly bought the books he loved through an agent.

Now, walking in the bright July sunshine, he felt sure that this year's robbery was going to be as successful as all the others. For two weeks he had been studying the house at Shotover Grange, looking at its rooms, its electric wiring, its paths and its garden. This afternoon the two servants, who remained in the Grange while the family was in London, had gone to the movies. Horace saw them go, and he felt happy in spite of a little tickle of hay fever in his nose. He came out from behind the garden wall, his tools carefully packed in a bag on his back.

i. Contradict the view that Horace Danby was rather careless in his work as a thief. (2)

Meticulous and observant— carefully planned the robbery after studying the movements of the house owner and the household staff--- looking at its rooms, its electric wiring, its paths and its garden--- learnt that family was in London--- two servants had gone to the movies that day—seek the opportune moment

ii. What prompted Danby to go on a yearly robbery?
(1)

Love of rare, expensive books that he could not afford to buy - hence the robbery

iii. How did Danby feel at the prospect of robbing the house at Shotover Grange? (1)

---- happy, optimistic

iv. Horace Danby appears to be..... 1

- a) extremely greedy
- b) a person with doubtful integrity
- c) a criminal with an unusual intellectual hobby
- d) a scholar

Select the correct set of options.

- 1) a and d
- 2) b and d
- 3) b and c
- 4) a and c

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer any one of the two.

(5)

A. But he's locked in a concrete cell,
His strength behind bars,
Stalking the length of his
cage, Ignoring visitors.

He hears the last voice at night,
The patrolling cars,
And stares with his brilliant eyes
At the brilliant stars.

- i. How does the poet introduce a picture of power curbed and grandeur crushed?
(2)

Tiger captivated in a concrete cell--- walking only within its confines instead of roaming in the wild and hunting its preys--- walking with settled rage , ignoring visitors--- helpless – lost its freedom

- ii. What can we infer about the emotional state of the tiger from this extract? (1)

Sad – knows anger is useless—longing for liberty

- iii. The poet compares the brilliance of the tiger's eyes with that of the stars to highlight the _____ of the tiger. (1)

(majesticity/inferiority)

- iv. The expression 'patrolling cars' have been used to reinforce the idea of _____.

(1)

- a. surveillance
- b. defiance
- c. freedom
- d. longing

OR

B. (I am Rapunzel, I have not a care;
life in a tower is tranquil and rare;
I'll certainly never let down my bright hair!)

- i. Which of the following best explains why Amanda chooses to compare herself with Rapunzel? (1)
- a. She has beautiful long hair which she wants to maintain in spite of her mother's anger.
- b. **She is burdened with restrictions and feels unjustly confined like Rapunzel does.**
- ii. Why does Amanda not want to let her hair down? (2)
- bowed under the burden of restrictions---- sad --- would not allow the world to intrude and disturb her peace**
- iii. Which of the following would correctly sum up Amanda's feelings, as evident from this extract? (1)
1. Desperation
 2. Indifference
 3. Defiance
 4. Despondency
- Select the correct set of options.
- a. 1 and 2
- b. 1, 2 and 4
- c. Only 2
- d. **1 and 3**
- iv. The use of parenthesis indicates that this is part of Amanda's _____. (1)
- imagination**

8. Answer any four of the following five questions in 40-50 words each.

(4 x 3= 12)

- a) In the poem 'Fog', mention the figure of speech in the expression ' little cat feet'. Explain why the poet uses the figure of speech .

Metaphor--- compares the movement of the cat with the appearance of the fog--- quietly, stealthily appears and disappears without giving one prior intimation--- also fog settles over the place for sometime and the cat sits on a vantage point surveying the surrounding before leaving

- b) How does the poet validate his opinion about the nature of human love in *For Anne Gregory*?

Human love is guided by one's appearance rather than by the beauty of the soul of one's beloved--- only God appreciates one for what she is--- poet brings in a reference to the holy man and scriptures as they are the repository of knowledge and wisdom

- c) Explain the poetic devices used in the description of a leopard in the poem *How to Tell Wild Animals*.

Metaphor – peppered with black spots ---- comparison—a surface dotted with pepper---skin is dotted with black spots which resemble pepper

Poetic licence-- 'lep' implying leap

Repetition of lep suggests the pouncing act of a leopard

- d) Do you think natural calamity and devastation of crops leave Lencho in despair? Justify your answer.

Lencho is certainly disappointed seeing the destruction of crops --- but not in a state of hopelessness or despair—has faith in God to set things right – wants to appeal to God

- e) How does the interaction between Nelson Mandela and the military officials show the change in the political scenario in South Africa on the Inauguration Day?

decorated military personnel----- once owed allegiance to a racist regime--- now acknowledges the establishment of a nonracial democratically elected government-- grace the occasion of the Inauguration by their presence---- fly past celebrates the victory over apartheid regime.

9. Answer any two of the following three questions in about 40-50 words. (2x3=6)

- a) Cite any two instances from *The Book That Saved the Earth* to show that the playwright criticizes the leaders who take decisions without understanding and knowledge through the portrayal of Think Tank.

Ignorance and overconfidence-pretends to know everything- calls the book a 'sandwich' and then 'a communication device' misinterprets the nursery rhymes as signs of Earth's military power- abandons the invasion—based on meaningless interpretations- lack of informed judgement

- b) What does Dr. Herriot mean by his comments 'Lunch became a ceremonial occasion.'?

Tricki started convalescing----Two eggs each for breakfast- two glasses of wine before and several during the meal, brandy- fine spirit was rolled around inhaled and reverently drunk- Lunch was like an elaborate ceremonial feast-they feasted on these delicacies as if to celebrate

- c) Why, according to Hari, is the prospect of robbing Anil different and more difficult than stealing from other people?

the greedy man shows fear-rich man shows anger---poor man shows acceptance-Anil-trusting man-kept the money under the mattress- no precaution- gave Hari the key to the door ----difficult to rob a careless man like Anil who doesn't notice -takes all the pleasure away from the work--- in Anil's face a touch of sadness-not due to the loss of money-but for the loss of trust.

10. Answer any one of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. (6)

- a) Accepting the inevitability of death in God's scheme of things brings one calm of mind. Substantiate the statement with reference to Kisa Gotami's tale.

Kisa Gotami - lost only son to death- approached Sakyamuni - to bring her son back to life - mustard seeds to be brought from a house where no one had died - futile effort to find such a house - realization - she had been selfish in her grief - inevitability of death – Death is the common destiny of all men-- immortality can be attained through selflessness - acceptance - calm and peace of mind.

- b) Real heroes do not need to brandish their valour. Keeping the statement in mind analyse why Custard can be called a real hero. Cite an instance of a real hero you came across, whose humility touched your heart.

Belinda's pets - Custard one of them - meek, cowardly, yearning for the safety of a cage -
- made fun of by Belinda and her other pets who bragged about their valour - pirate's attack
- everyone else fled - Custard rose to the occasion - protected his mistress - killed the pirate
- a true hero who did not need to flaunt his prowess - his actions proved it Extrapolation

11. Answer any one of the following two questions in about 100-120 words.

(6)

- a) Contrary to Fowler's initial impression of Ausable, the latter perfectly fits the bill to be a spy. Explain how true the statement is with reference to *The Midnight Visitor*. Cite an instance from your own experience of meeting an individual who surprised you by turning out to be exactly the opposite of what he had appeared at the beginning.

○ Ausable --- initial impression - not dashing - unimpressive physical appearance - encounter with Max - how Ausable outsmarted him - an ideal spy - presence of mind - ingenious - could be ruthless if the situation demanded - was in total control of the situation - remained unfazed even after being threatened - calm and composed .

○ Extrapolation

- b) A teacher plays a significant role in bringing about a positive change in a student's life. Explain how this idea is reflected through *Bholi* with a special mention to Bholi's unimaginable transformation as delineated in the story.

Bholi - pock marks on face - stammered - was considered dumb by others, hence 'Bholi'- everyone ridiculed her - neglected by her family - sent to school - teacher – encouraged and motivated her - notwithstanding the initial hurdles, she got educated, enlightened, became aware of her rights - on the day of wedding, protested against one of the social evils - didn't falter to speak against the dowry system - independent spirit - ready to work for a living and shoulder responsibility of parents - Bholi was now Sulekha, the woman who had carved out a niche for herself in society..
